

BEYOND THE KINGDOM — Season 1 Storylines

Document 10 · Locked Canon · Season 1: "The Arrival" (Episodes #0001–#0180, January 3 – September 16, 2005)

The Season in One Sentence

When the Smilleys plant their tower across Peachtree Road from the Donohues, Atlanta's Black royalty goes to war, and the secrets buried under Belmont Crest (a masked night, a missing man, a dead man who isn't dead, and a king nobody can see) begin to surface, one by one, until they explode at a wedding.

Season Architecture

Phase	Episodes	Dates	Engine
I. The Arrival	#1–#22	Jan 3 – Feb 2	The Smilleys land. The Onyx Coin killings begin. Near-misses between Marc and Esther.
II. February Sweeps: "The Countdown"	#23–#42	Feb 3 – Mar 2	The Onyx Coin Killer. The Sovereign Broadcast. Marc and Esther's first meeting.
III. Crowns & Letters	#43–#82	Mar 3 – Apr 27	The Centennial Ball. The stolen Savannah Letter. The man with a new face.
IV. May Sweeps: "The Crash-Out"	#83–#102	Apr 28 – May 25	Grace's abuser. Marc's arrest. Alvin returns (#90) . The 100th episode kiss. The House of Smiley implodes.
V. The Long Hot Summer	#103–#166	May 26 – Aug 25	Dee's wallet. The Right Hand walks. Harlow hunts. The queens' road trip. The DNA test.
VI. The Storm & the Wedding	#167–#180	Aug 26 – Sep 16	Katrina. Theodore returns (#176) . The wedding. Gunfire. "The girls are yours."

A-STORIES (Tentpole Arcs)

1. "THE WOMAN IN THE GOLD MASK" — Marc & Esther

Logline: Heirs to rival dynasties fall in love while one of them hides that they already share two daughters.

- **Never-before-seen hook:** The father meets his daughters before he formally meets their mother. Marc bonds with Victoria at Lenox Square (#18), rescues her again when she crosses the ravine (#91), and plays the dragon at Lyric's party (#77), all before he knows. The audience watches a father fall in love with his children in real time while he has no idea.

- **Beats:**
 - Near-misses: the Crown Gate (#3), the jasmine at church (#11), the adjoining rooms (#33)
 - First meeting (#42–43)
 - Three dances at the Centennial Ball (#50)
 - The library standoff (#68)
 - "She's got my laugh" (#92)
 - **First kiss, in the rain on the Hotel Donohue roof (100th episode)**
 - Celeste's kiss sends Esther away (#105)
 - The motel confession: he's been searching for the gold-mask girl for four years (#157)
 - Katrina brings them together (#170–171)
 - "Give me one reason" (#178)
 - **Finale: "The girls are yours!" (#180)**
- **Season 2 question:** Did Marc hear her?

2. "WHO IS SOVEREIGN?" — *The Hunt*

Logline: The Chief of Police, the FBI, a star reporter, and a murderous cousin all hunt Atlanta's invisible crime king, and he's at their Sunday dinner.

- **Never-before-seen hook: The Sovereign Broadcast (#38).** The villain-hero hijacks a live local newscast to promise the police chief, who is secretly his sister, a killer delivered to her door in seven days, and then keeps the promise (#42).
- **Beats:**
 - The Onyx Coin killings frame Blackwater (#1–#23)
 - "SOVEREIGN = BULLOCK": Robert is questioned (#23–24)
 - Celeste's exposé ends her relationship with Marc (#26)
 - The countdown (#38–#42)
 - Martin's investigation: Harlow tells him "two boys came" (#149), Martin stages a test (#165), and **he knows (#180)**
 - Doyle learns Robert is Sovereign's lawyer (#146)
 - Hughes leaks Amond as a target (#161)
 - Harmony wears a wire (#162–163)

3. "THE GHOST OF DEE DIVINE" — *Harmony, Arianna, Marc & Amond*

Logline: A woman searching for her missing brother turns to the new DA for help, not knowing the DA killed him and her best friend's secret love buried the truth.

- **Never-before-seen hook:** The killer is the one assigned to solve the case. Harmony begs Arianna to reopen it (#4) and hires Marc's company to search for Dee (#40), so the two people who buried him are officially looking for him.
- **Beats:**
 - The flashback special reveals the truth to the audience (#35)
 - Esther's investigators find Northside Drive (#64), and Esther uses it against Arianna (#67)
 - Arianna writes a confession letter, and Knox steals it (#117–118). Martin blackmails her (#120).
 - Silas mails Dee's wallet (#134), and the Divines learn Dee is dead (#135)
 - Amond learns Blackwater delivered a body (#136) and punches Marc into the Chattahoochee (#137)
 - A funeral without a body (#139)
 - Harmony confronts Arianna, and Martin interrupts (#142)
 - **The mailed confession arrives on the wedding day (#179–180)**

4. "HOUSE OF SMILLEY" — *The Enemy's Civil War*

Logline: The Smilleys' move into enemy territory unravels their own family: a secret illness, a secret father, and an heir nobody wanted.

- **Beats:**
 - Luke and Delphine's resentment (#7, #16)
 - Noelle steals the Savannah Letter (#54–55)
 - Lucius collapses (#94) and his Parkinson's is leaked (#95)
 - Desmond tells Martin "Luke is mine" (#96). Delphine finds the 1975 letters (#97) and throws the truth at Luke (#101).
 - **Lucius hears everything from his hospital bed (#102)** and rewrites the succession (#103)
 - Desmond and Luke join Martin's alliance (#104)

B-STORIES

5. "THE TOWER WAR" — *The Auburn Avenue Revival*

Logline: DGH and Smiley International fight over the \$4 billion redevelopment of Sweet Auburn, where Alexander Donohue began.

- **Never-before-seen twist:** Esther wins by bribing a councilman (#98). Marc answers with the deeds to Alexander's original 31 parcels, and **turns her victory into a forced partnership** (#99–100). The rivals become business partners without a single handshake.

6. "LYRIC'S LAW" — *Amond & Harmony*

Logline: Two strangers who share a daughter are forced into one penthouse by danger, and into each other's arms by everything else.

- **Beats:**
 - Gloria's grandparent-visitation petition (#9)
 - The evaluator (#17)
 - The nursery break-in (#29) and moving into the penthouse (#30)
 - Sleeping together after the ball (#52)
 - The Grady night (#116)
 - The Juneteenth kiss (#119)
 - Amond's break with Marc (#137)
 - The wire (#162–163)
 - **She reads the confession and looks at him (#180)**

7. "THE NEPOTISM CHIEF" — *Elxa & Jeremy*

Logline: A by-the-book police chief learns her appointment was bought by the family she refuses to owe.

- **Beats:**
 - Hughes' leaks (#9)
 - The no-confidence hearing and the Hardaway letter (#72)
 - Jeremy hides the truth (#73) and finally tells her (#108)
 - The resignation letter (#108), which the mayor refuses (#110)
 - A pregnancy revealed in an evidence bag (#160)
 - Katrina hits on her forgotten 25th birthday (#168)

8. "GRACE UNDER FIRE" — *Grace, Derrick & the Monster*

Logline: A pop star hides her abuse from her family until her brother sees one photograph.

- **Never-before-seen hook: The hero's arrest is the sweeps climax.** Marc flips the abuser's Bentley in the middle of Peachtree Road, and **his own sister, the Chief, arrests him (#84).** That arrest triggers the Disgrace Clause vote, which **Alvin, returning from Miami, decides with his first on-screen act (#90).**

9. "GRACE & GLORY" — *The Beauty War*

Logline: Two heiresses build a brand on their great-grandmother's 1935 formulas, until the enemy copies them.

- **Beats:**
 - Simone's condition: "Beat the Smilleys" (#4)
 - The formula is copied as "Odessa Glow" (#62)
 - The lawsuit shows the leak was a bribed chemist (#112)
 - **The launch sells out in 11 minutes (#145)**

10. *"FORBIDDEN FRUIT" — Mallory & Quentin*

Logline: Romeo and Juliet in Buckhead: the Olsons' miracle child and the Smilleys' wild card.

- **Beats:**
 - "Q" (#8)
 - The sunflower (#13)
 - The gazebo kiss (#51)
 - Desmond orders Quentin to spy (#61)
 - The confession, and the gift thrown into Lake Simone (#111)
 - **Quentin saves her from a sabotaged car (#126)** and defies his father (#127)
- Mallory's choice to wait is treated with respect. Quentin's love is proven by his patience.

11. *"THE MAN WITH A NEW FACE" — Harlow Returns*

Logline: The monster Blackwater thought it destroyed in 2000 comes back wearing a face built by a Donohue son-in-law.

- **Never-before-seen hook: The villain's face was sculpted by a member of the hero's family.** Peter unknowingly created the disguise that lets Harlow into Belmont Crest society, and Alvin unknowingly gives him a nightclub.
- **Beats:**
 - The anonymous photos (#13, #57)
 - "You gave me a new life" (#74)
 - The Cancún flashback (#75)
 - The threat to Mallory (#76), and her brakes fail (#126)
 - Marc sees his eyes (#128)
 - The white rose (#130)
 - The fingerprint (#132), which is thrown out (#133)
 - "Two boys came" (#149)
 - **He walks the wedding grounds as a florist (#175)**
 - **The gunfire (#180)**

12. "THE PRODIGAL PRINCE" — Alvin (from Episode #90)

Logline: The family's black sheep lands in the middle of a family civil war, and brings a wolf with him.

- **Beats:**
 - His helicopter entrance and swing vote (#90)
 - The Sunday roast and Silas's funeral wreath (#93)
 - The bender with Harlow, where he leaks Grace's secret (#115)
 - Defending "Julian" (#133)
 - Coming face to face with his unknown son Tremaine (#159)

13. "KINGS AND PAWNS" — Martin's Conspiracy

Logline: The passed-over grandson assembles a secret alliance of enemies to destroy the Heir Apparent, guided by a voice from exile.

- **Never-before-seen hook:** For 175 episodes, **the audience hears only Martin's side of his calls.** The identity of the "Voice" is the season's slow-burn mystery, solved when **Theodore Donohue returns (#176).**
- **Beats:**
 - The Desmond pact (#8)
 - Knox and the Onyx killings (#10–#41)
 - The Disgrace petition (#85), which fails at the swing vote (#90)
 - The alliance widens to Desmond, Luke, Knox, and Harlow (#104, #148)
 - Arianna's letter (#118)
 - **The DNA test: 99.99% (#166–173)**
 - "Come home. It's time." (#173)

14. "THE OTHER WOMAN WEARS A WIRE" — Robert, Natasha & Camille

Logline: A wife discovers her husband's mistress and hires her, and the mistress turns out to be working for the FBI.

- **Beats:**
 - The Smile perfume (#6)
 - Natasha buys the hotel where they meet (#32)
 - Natasha hires Camille as DGH's General Counsel at triple salary (#65)
 - The Bullocks reunite as partners in crime (#107)
 - Camille wears the wire (#114) and catches "Sovereign's people pay" (#146)
 - She's discovered: "I'm pregnant. It's his." (#147)
 - The grand jury (#175)

C-STORIES & RUNNERS

15. "THE SAVANNAH LETTER" — Simone & Odessa

Logline: Two matriarchs in their 80s and 90s discover the truth behind their families' 53-year war, and decide to keep it to themselves.

- **Never-before-seen hook: Daytime's first road trip between two elderly queens.** Simone and Odessa escape their security and drive to Savannah together in a 1958 Cadillac (#154–157). Their grandchildren chase them, and it traps the lovers in a one-room motel.
- **Beats:**
 - The Centennial Ball face-off (#50)
 - The theft (#50–55)
 - Tea at the Swan Coach House (#63)
 - They read the letter together: "It was always me." (#123)
 - The secret pact (#124)

16. "THE CONGRESSWOMAN'S GAMBIT" — Jasmine & Peter

Jasmine's 2006 run for governor (#57, #124) collides with Peter's secret surgery on Harlow (#125). Her public ambition stays blind to Martin's private darkness.

17. "THE UNKNOWN DONOHUE" — Tremaine

Marc spots Victor's eyes on a boy in his mentoring program (#113). Alvin meets his son (#159). This runner gets a full arc in Season 2.

18. "THE STORM" — Katrina

- **Real-event arc, handled with respect.** BSI Crisis Response and Blackwater's Tithe pour into New Orleans, Simone's hometown.
- Esther opens every Smilley hotel to evacuees, the rival heirs run a joint relief center, and Simone's great-nephew is rescued.
- **Every Atlanta shelter is funded anonymously with an Onyx Coin (#172),** and Sovereign becomes a national legend.

19. "THE RETURN OF THE EXILES" — Theodore's Branch (#176–180)

The two-year exile ends. Theodore, Reginald, and Connie arrive in finale week. The "Voice" is revealed, Connie is revealed to be CrestWatch (#179), and an emergency Crown Council is called for October. **They become Core Contract Cast in Season 2.**

THE SEASON FINALE — "The Wedding" (Episode #180, Friday, September 16, 2005)

Cliffhangers (the Season 2 questions):

1. **Who was shot?** Blood spreads across Esther's gown. Is it Marc's, Esther's, or one of the twins'?
 2. **Did Marc hear "The girls are yours"?**
 3. **Harmony has Arianna's confession.** What will she do, and how much does Amond know?
 4. **Martin knows everything.** He knows Sovereign's identity and the twins' paternity, and he has Theodore at his side.
 5. **Was Harlow the shooter, or was someone else in the trees?**
 6. **Did Esther say "I do"?**
 7. **Camille's grand jury testimony and her baby.** Can Robert survive either one?
 8. **The October Crown Council.** Theodore is back for the crown.
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Story-Balance Guide (Weekly Rotation Targets)

Storyline	Share of Season 1 Screen Time
Marc & Esther (Gold Mask)	18%
Who Is Sovereign? / Martin's conspiracy	16%
The Ghost of Dee Divine / Amond & Harmony	16%
House of Smiley / Tower War	14%
Grace (Under Fire and Grace & Glory)	10%
Elxa & Jeremy	8%
Harlow / Peter & Jasmine	7%
Robert, Natasha & Camille	5%
Mallory & Quentin	4%
Simone & Odessa / Alvin / Tremaine / runners	2%

See Document 11 for all 180 episode synopses.